EXPERIMENT 9 - LAB RECORD

# Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

*Dashboard, Kanban report and Zia assistant for the Appointment_Booking_Form application*

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| Application | Appointment_Booking_Form (Zoho Creator) |
| Platform | Zoho Creator (low-code) with Zia, Zoho's AI assistant |

## 1. Aim

To explore the built-in analytics and AI-assisted features of Zoho Creator by reviewing the application's dashboard, a Kanban report and a list report, and by asking Zia (the Build Agent) to add conditional formatting, in order to understand how form data becomes visual insight with little or no custom code.

### Objectives

- Review the Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard, which combines a chart and a report.
- Study the Kanban report appointment_report, grouped by Department.
- Review the list report Appointment_Booking_Form Report as the source data.
- Try Zia to apply conditional formatting and record the result honestly.

### Software and tools

- Zoho Creator with the Appointment_Booking_Form application
- Web browser with internet access
- Zoho account with access to Edit and Access (live) modes

## 2. Theory

**Built-in analytics.** Zoho Creator turns form records into summaries without a separate BI tool. A dashboard can combine charts and embedded reports; a Kanban report groups records into columns by a chosen field; and list reports show the underlying records. All of them read live data from the application's forms, so they update automatically when records change.

**Zia.** Zia is Zoho's AI assistant. In Creator the Build Agent accepts plain-language instructions about forms, reports and dashboards and applies them to the application. It can apply changes directly to the live app, and it may report an error when a requested change cannot be configured.

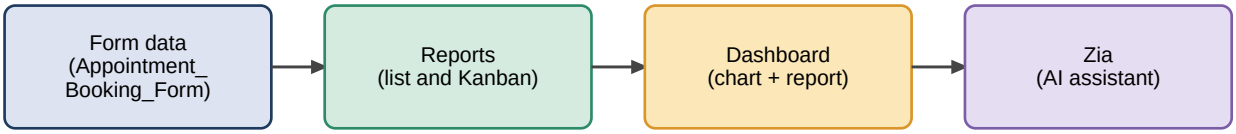



*Fig. 1: From form data to reports, dashboard and Zia.*

| Concept | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Dashboard | A page that combines charts and embedded reports into one overview of application data. |
| Chart | A visual element, such as a bar chart, that summarises records by a chosen field. |

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| Concept | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Kanban report | A board-style report that groups records into columns by a field such as Department. |
| List report | A table of the records stored in a form. |
| Conditional formatting | A report rule that colours cells or rows by value so patterns stand out. |
| Zia (Build Agent) | An AI assistant that applies plain-language instructions to the application. |

| Parameter | Detail |
|---|---|
| Application | Appointment_Booking_Form |
| Form fields | Patient name, Age, Gender, Email, Contact number, Residential address, Referred by |
| Dashboard | Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard: Appointment_Booking_Form Report (View button), age chart by department, appointment_report |
| Kanban report | appointment_report, columns grouped by Department |
| List report | Appointment_Booking_Form Report (8 records) |

# 3. Procedure

**1. Open the dashboard** — Open the application in Access mode and click Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard. It shows the Appointment_Booking_Form Report with a View button, a chart of age by department and the appointment_report below it.

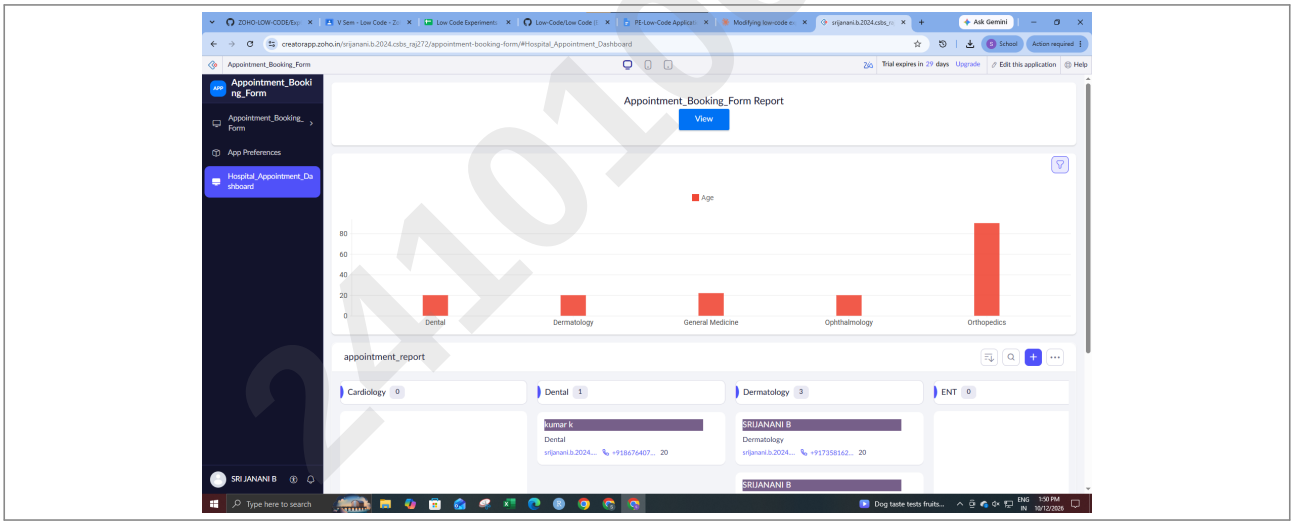



*Figure 9.1: Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard*

**2. Check the Kanban properties** — In Edit mode open appointment_report. Under Kanban Properties the report is grouped by Department, empty and deleted value columns are hidden, columns sort ascending and the record count per column is shown.

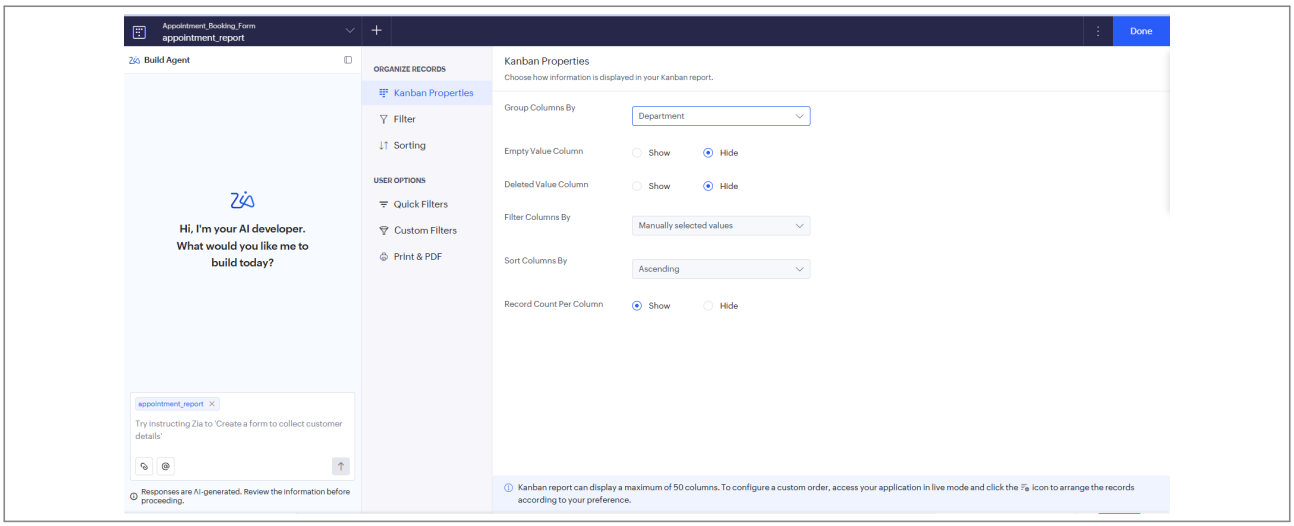



*Figure 9.2: Kanban Properties of appointment_report*

**3. View the Kanban board** — Open appointment_report in Access mode. Records appear as cards under department columns: Cardiology 0, Dental 1, Dermatology 3 and ENT 0, with empty columns labelled "No Records".

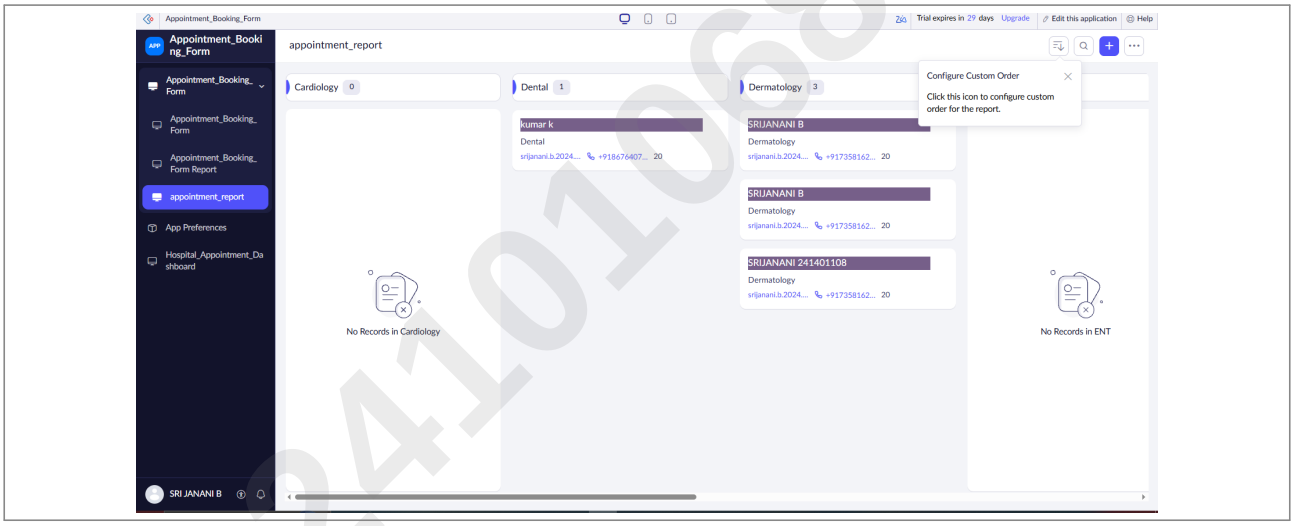



*Figure 9.3: appointment_report Kanban board*

**4. Review the list report** — Open Appointment_Booking_Form Report. It lists all 8 records with patient name, address, age, gender, email, contact number and referral source. This is the data the chart and board are built on.

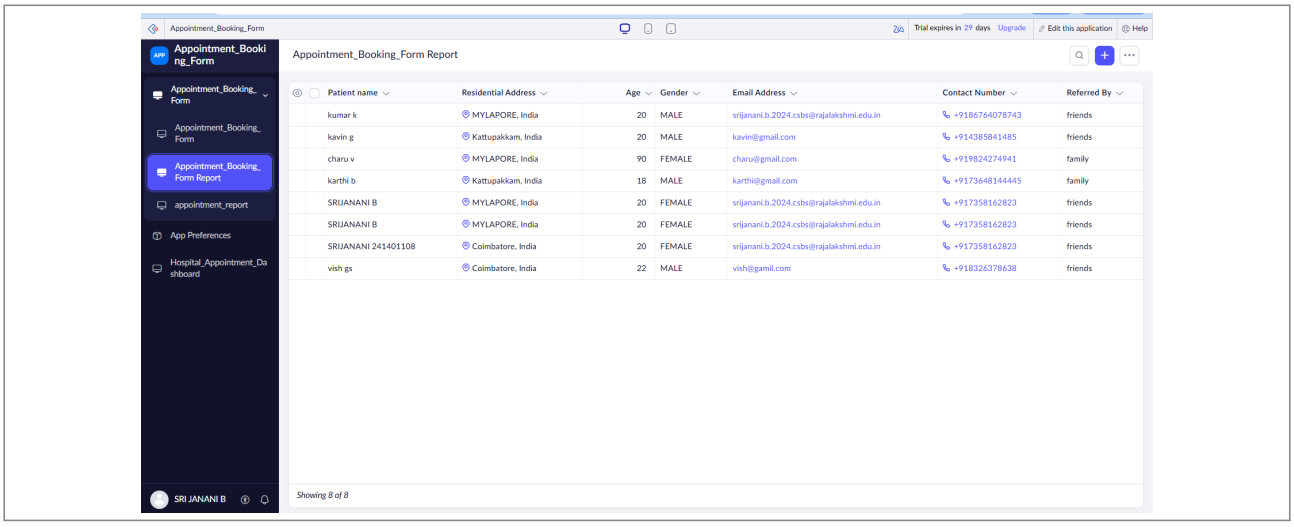



*Figure 9.4: Appointment_Booking_Form Report*

**5. Ask Zia to add conditional formatting** — In the Build Agent chat the instruction was entered: colour the Department column red when it is Orthopedics and green when it is Dental. Zia replied that it cannot currently configure conditional formatting for this report because of a schema validation error and advised setting it up manually.

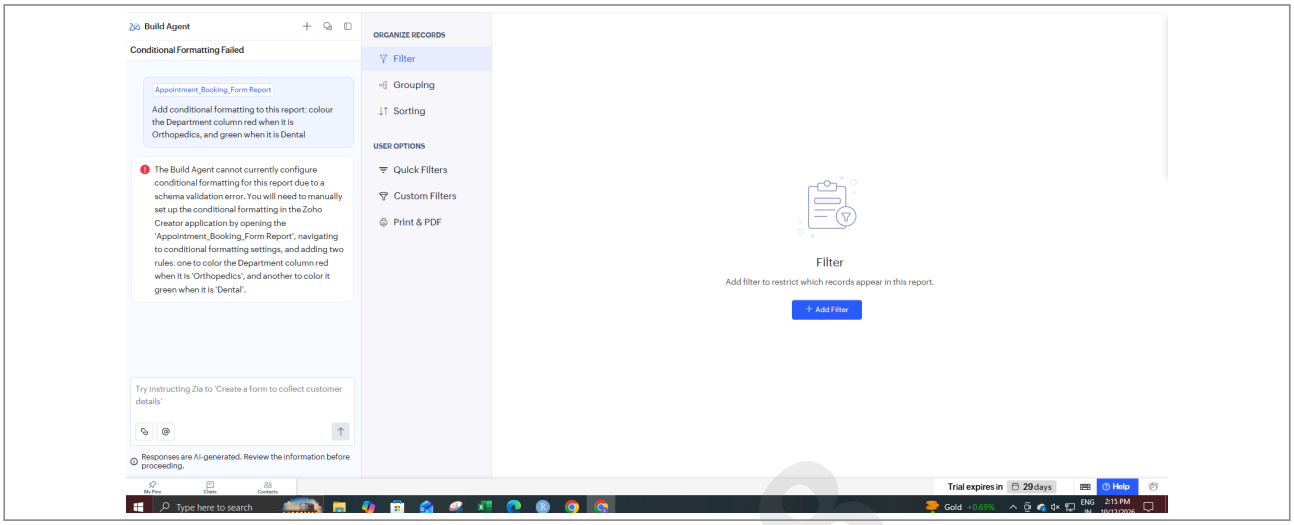



*Figure 9.5: Zia reply - Conditional Formatting Failed*

*Note: a manual conditional-formatting option was not found in the report builder screens used in this experiment (the report menu offered only Rename, Duplicate and Delete), so conditional formatting was not applied.*

## 4. Observations

- The dashboard combines a chart and a live report on one page without custom code.
- The Kanban board groups the same appointment records by Department and shows a count per column; Dermatology holds the most records (3).
- The list report shows all 8 records, which are the single source for the chart and the board.
- Zia could not apply the conditional-formatting request, so AI-assisted changes should be checked and may need manual setup.

## 5. Result

- The Hospital_Appointment_Dashboard was reviewed, with its chart and embedded report.
- The Kanban report appointment_report was reviewed in Edit and Access modes.
- The Appointment_Booking_Form Report was reviewed as the underlying data.
- Zia was tried for conditional formatting; it returned a schema validation error and the formatting was not applied.

## 6. Conclusion

The experiment showed how Zoho Creator's built-in analytics turn form records into a dashboard, a Kanban board and list reports without custom charting code, all driven by the same form data. Zia can accept plain-language instructions, but in this case it could not configure conditional formatting, which shows that AI-assisted changes need to be verified and sometimes completed by hand.

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